



Leaving a mark: Seventeen-year-old Aditi Swami has been one of the breakout stars in Indian archery.

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need to elevate their game and strengthen their team bonding. This is important as the experienced Deepika Kumari has not been part of the side of late, and there is no certainty of her comeback.

Ahead of the Olympics, the elite recurve athletes mean business. The archer couple of Atanu-Deepika and Dhiraj spent some time training separately in Korea in recent weeks to fine-tune their skills.

The archers have to go through the rigours of a series of complex selection trials spread over several months to prove themselves for the qualifiers and the Olympics.

Some archers getting nominated for World Archery (WA) awards is a proud moment for Indian archery and should inspire the recurve archers to perform even better in the Olympic year.

Sheetal Devi, who medalled in

the World Para-Archery Championships and the Asian Games and was later nominated for the WA Awards, caught everyone's attention and brought more glory to the nation.

Sheetal was adjudged the Best Para Woman Athlete of the Year 2023. For their superb performances in 2023, Sheetal, Aditi, and Deotale were selected for the prestigious Arjuna Award.

The overall success of Indian archers is an outcome of a comprehensive approach, covering every aspect of the sport, adopted

by the Archery Association of India (AAI).

Amidst the upswing in Indian archery in the year gone by, one wonders whether its archers can achieve the much-longed-for medal in Paris 2024 and bring an end to their also-ran tag in the Olympics for so many years. Winning an Olympic medal can also benefit the profile of archery in India. It can attract more corporate sponsorships and talented individuals to the sport, which has started flourishing by expanding infrastructure and competitions.

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